In this context, I believe it is imperative to begin by establishing the reason why the oldest political party in our country, the Indian National Congress, decided to embark on this prodigious journey. The assumption voiced as an opinion by many people—that the ultimate goal of this Yatra was electoral gain—is understandable, given that the initiative was spearheaded by a political party. However, it could not be further from the truth. Electoral benefit was nowhere on the agenda of the people leading the Yatra. The Yatra began in Tamil Nadu's Kanyakumari at a time when there were no elections in the state or the constituency, and the parliamentary elections were also a couple of years away. In fact, contrary to the assumption, the leadership was clear that the primary objective of the Yatra was to embrace and promote love, non-violence, unity and truth among fellow Indians and resist the atmosphere of hatred, violence, fear and division gripping the nation day by day.

There are many conscientious Indians who share my observation and opinion that the intent of the ruling dispensation is suspicious and questionable. The actions of the current government astutely remind us of the divide-and-rule tactics used by the British to establish colonial rule. Today fear, hatred and divisiveness are being insidiously deployed to divide the nation so that the ruling dispensation can divert our attention from the genuine grassroots issues. Much like the days of the Raj, the hard-earned labour of Indians is again being transferred into the pockets of crony capitalists, giving them control over the nation's future bit by bit.

Moreover, the drastic measures taken by the ruling party to suppress the democratic voices of dissent and opposition further remind us of the country's colonial rulers in the past. Many have been tempted into silence by power and money. Whoever has dared to openly oppose the actions of the government is being suppressed using brute force, coercion tactics and institutional abuse such as false police cases. No one has been spared, be it social organizations, activists, political parties, leaders, soldiers, journalists, writers, artists, students or farmers. The current government's blatant disregard for India's constitutional democracy became more evident when they began arbitrarily suspending elected representatives to the Lok Sabha